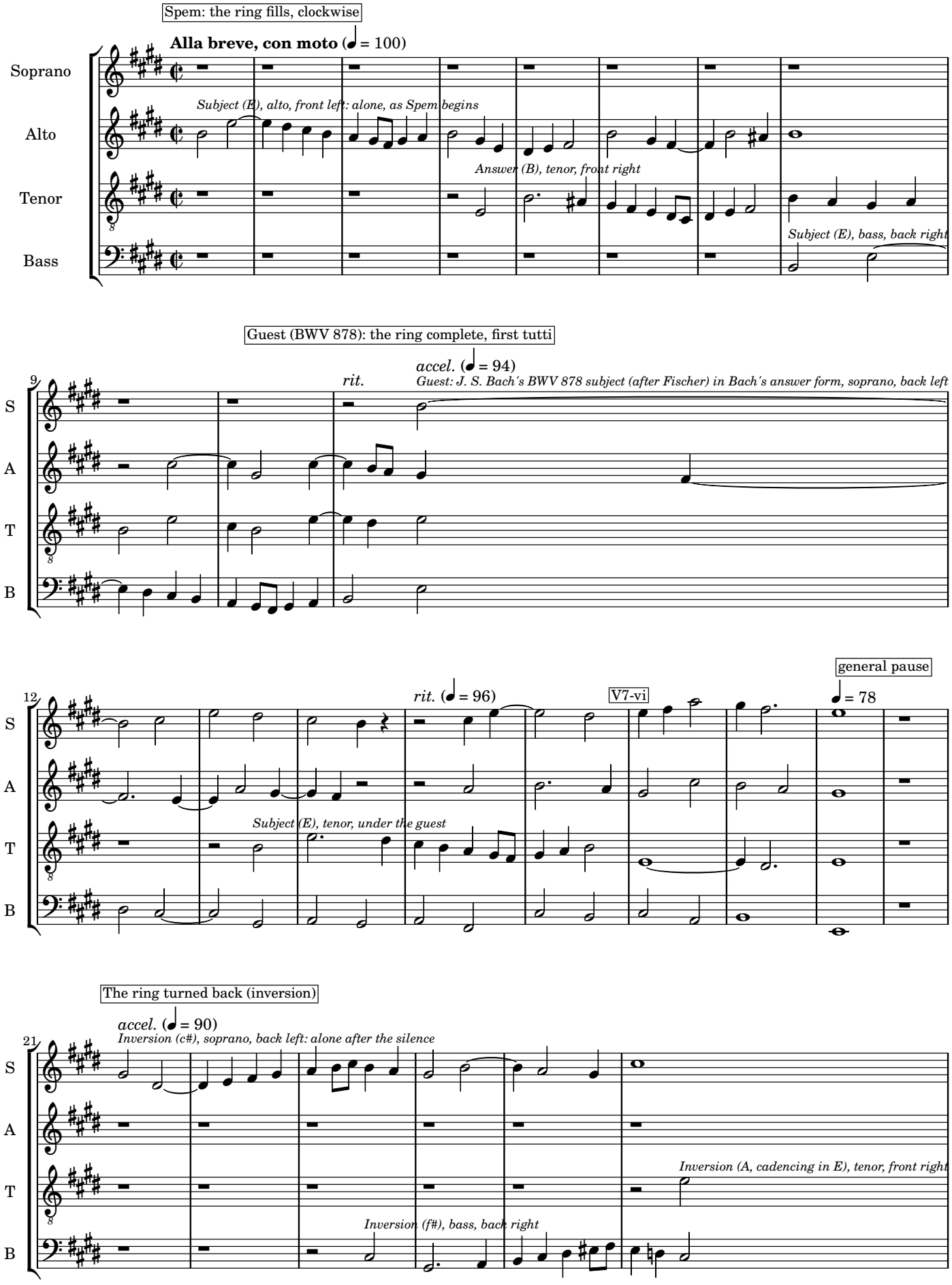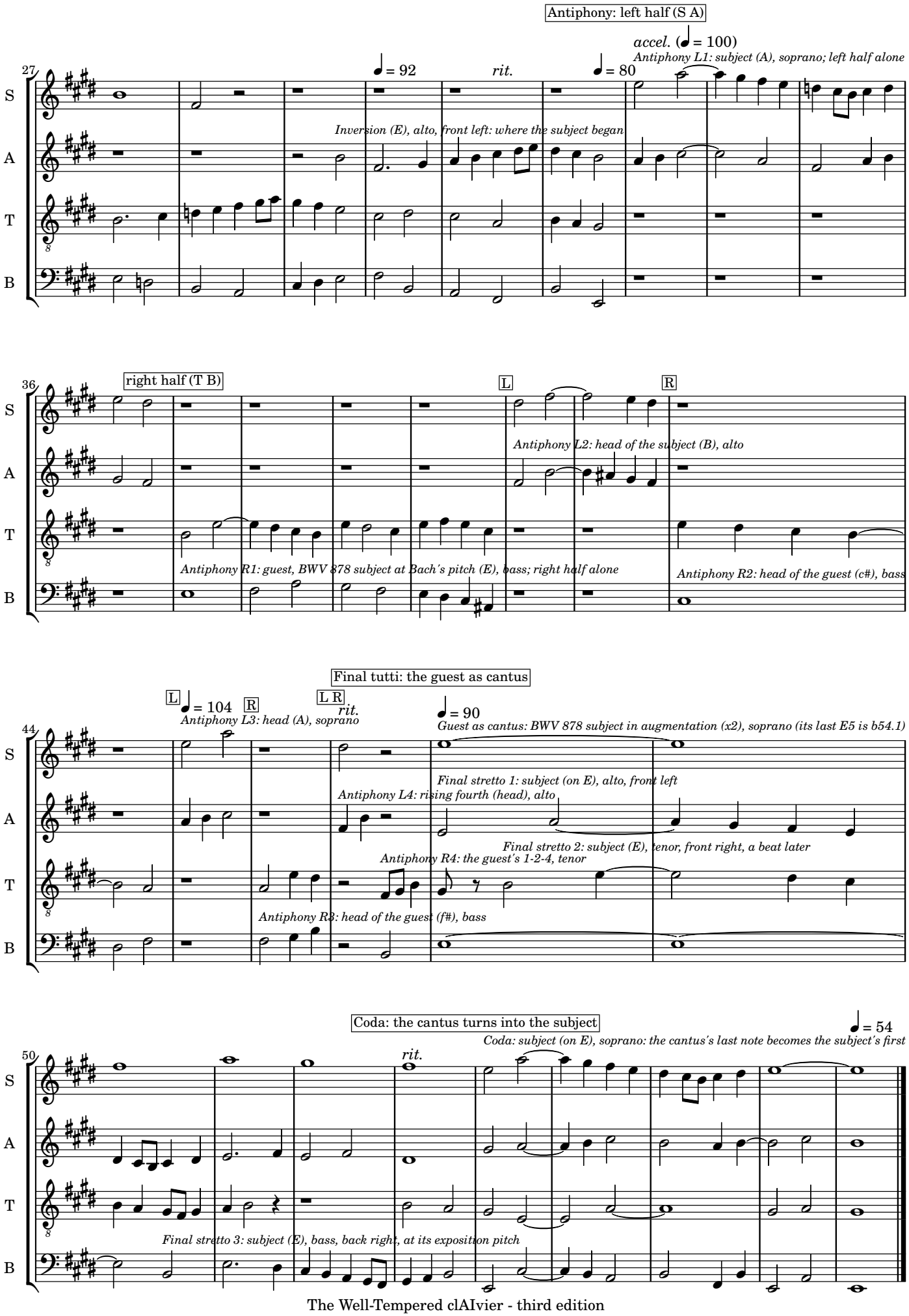The Well-Tempered clAIvier

IX. Fugue in E major (a 4): Ricercar in circulo

Keyboard - four voices (four singers in a ring)

Original composition (Claude) for Sam; guest subject J. S. Bach, BWV 878 (after J. C. F. Fischer)




Antiphony: left half (S A)
accel. (♩ = 100)
Antiphony L1: subject (A), soprano; left half alone
27
♩ = 92
rit.
♩ = 80
S
A
T
B
Inversion (E), alto, front left: where the subject began
right half (T B)
36
L
R
Antiphony L2: head of the subject (B), alto
Antiphony R1: guest, BWV 878 subject at Bach's pitch (E), bass; right half alone
Antiphony R2: head of the guest (c#), bass
Final tutti: the guest as cantus
L
♩ = 104
R
L R
rit.
44
♩ = 90
Guest as cantus: BWV 878 subject in augmentation (x2), soprano (its last E5 is b54.1)
Antiphony L3: head (A), soprano
Final stretto 1: subject (on E), alto, front left
Antiphony L4: rising fourth (head), alto
Final stretto 2: subject (E), tenor, front right, a beat later
Antiphony R4: the guest's 1-2-4, tenor
Antiphony R3: head of the guest (f#), bass
Coda: the cantus turns into the subject
♩ = 54
Coda: subject (on E), soprano: the cantus's last note becomes the subject's first
50
rit.
Final stretto 3: subject (E), bass, back right, at its exposition pitch